One Last Wound From Beyond The Grave

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Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
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Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Angst, Heavy Angst, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Canon, Post-Canon, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Manipulative Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Abusive Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Homophobia, Internalized Homophobia, well as close as you can get to that with Canon She-Ra, Past Abuse, Abuse, Implied/Referenced Torture, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse, Memory Loss, Memory Alteration, Mind Wipes, Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra)

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Part 44 of Catradora: After The End

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by TheStarGayzingEtherianCollection (TheStarGayzingEtherian)

Summary

Long after her death, Shadow Weaver still finds ways of hurting Adora and Catra. (Catradora, Canon, Angst)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Even in death, Shadow Weaver still managed to find some ways of hurting Adora and Catra, that even if she was no longer of this world, somehow the witch's black tendrils would find their way to ensure her former wards and bring them pain and suffering. This latest pain though… was the worst.

It began after Entrapta had decoded some coordinates from the Horde's old database that led Adora and Catra to one of Shadow Weaver's personal supply caches. The sorceress had dozens of them, all over the former Horde territories, where she'd hoarded various magical artifacts the Horde had confiscated, as well as various personal items that she'd felt too dangerous to keep in the Fright Zone.

Recovering what they could from the small outpost, one item caught Adora and Catra's eye in particular. It was a volume of Shadow Weaver's personal journal. While the others put the other magical relics and items in a safe place, Adora and Catra took the journal back to Brightmoon with them.

They knew they shouldn't have done it, that there'd be something in there that they'd regret reading. But in a way, they felt compelled to. As if there was something magical about the old tome that was drawing them to it curiously. They had to know what Shadow Weaver knew, all the witch's dark secrets.

In their room late that night, Catra and Adora went through the passages, reading them to one another. It wasn't every entry of the journal and it definitely stopped after a certain point, but just this volume alone was enough to satiate the dark desire within Catra and Adora.

"Entry six-four-seven," Catra read aloud a particularly traumatising entry "That brat Catra tried to sneak into my chambers again. I had to punish her severely again. Perhaps I went a bit too hard with the torture but… well, Catra won't know, I erased her mind and healed her wounds."

Adora felt her blood run cold. “She… She really did that?”

“I always thought I had the worst of what she dealt us,” Catra admitted. “But… god, I never knew it was this bad.”

“I mean, you didn’t,” Adora then said, putting a hand on her girlfriend’s shoulder. “As she said, she wiped your memory.”

“Yeah but I don’t think she erased the fear I got from her… I was scared bad.”

“But you’re stronger now,” Adora reminded her. “We’re stronger now, she can’t hurt us.” She looked at the pages. “You sure you wanna keep going? We could pick it up tomorrow.”

“No… I’m fine,” Catra said. “I need to know what she wrote.”

Adora nodded. “Alright, if you’re sure.”

Catra cleared her throat, beginning to read another entry. “Entry six-seven-three. Adora is showing much potential as a Horde Officer. She’s doing exceedingly well in her cadet training. Lord Hordak thinks she might be worthy of Force Captain someday, but I know he sees a grander purpose for her. I think he forgets how he pawned her off on me to deal with when he found the girl all those years ago. No, Adora will be mine, not Hordak’s and soon, I’ll be fully running this operation… and Adora will be my secret weapon.”

“Typical,” Adora remarked. “We never meant anything to her… she used us. Even if she favoured me, she just favoured what I could do for her.”

“You think… she ever knew you’d become She-Ra?” Catra wondered.

Adora shook her head. “Doubt it. She couldn’t see the future… but if she had… She-Ra working for the Horde.”

“You’d have killed everyone,” Catra admitted. “Thank heavens that’s not how things played out.”

Nodding, Adora took the journal, reading the next entry. “Entry eight-eight-two. I caught Adora and Catra running around the hallways again. Catra’s a bad influence on Adora. I could very easily just get rid of her and wipe Adora’s memory of the vermin and she’d never know. But… part of me wants to make Adora happy. After all, a happy slave doesn’t disobey her master. But still, I’ll need to keep a further eye on this.”

Catra was taken aback. “Oh… that bitch. She actually thought it. You know, I sometimes used to wonder if she’d actually considered it, actually killing me and wiping your mind so you’d never know.”

“You know, if she did wipe our minds as much as she says she did in this,” Adora wondered. “How… How much don’t we remember from our childhood?”

“You sure that’s a question you wanna ask?” Catra admitted.

“Catra… who knows how many memories we’re missing,” Adora said. “We were under that woman’s thrall for eighteen years. Who knows what she did?”

“Adora, if it’s one thing I’ve learned,” Catra then replied. “It’s that sometimes… some questions are better left unanswered.”

“I know but the more I keep reading these… the more I think.”

“Are you sure you want to keep going?” Catra wondered, repeating what Adora had asked her before. “Sounds like these are starting to mess you up.”

“I’ll… I’ll manage,” Adora said. “I need to know too, I need to know what she hid from us. I don’t want any more secrets.”

“Alright,” Catra accepted, holding Adora’s hand as they began the next page of entries.

On and on they went, learning Shadow Weaver's secrets and forgotten memories from their past. They learned how Catra was a guinea pig for Shadow Weaver's most brutal of experiments, yet the witch used her magic to cover up any sign that she'd done any harm to Catra at all.

They learned how Adora had more friends than she and Catra remembered, but Shadow Weaver manipulated things so they'd be left isolated from a lot of the other cadets, eventually wiping their memories completely of them. As for those lost friends… well the journal didn't exactly say, but Adora and Catra could hazard a guess of what happened to them.

Shadow Weaver had been controlling so many aspects of their lives, more than they ever realised. She wanted them to think like obedient slaves and not question anything she taught them. Anytime that it had ever been noted that Adora had disobeyed, another memory wipe. Catra was allowed to keep her memories, to keep her second to Adora.

And then, Catra and Adora came to the most hurtful passage of them all, an entry that sent both of them spiralling into a blind rage at their deceased abuser.

"Entry three-zero-two-five," Catra spoke. "I can't believe what I saw today. Adora went out with Catra again to that spot on the roof, breaking curfew. Normally, that would be the worst of it, but I saw them talking to each other, Adora holding Catra's hand. They said they loved each other… and Adora kissed Catra on the lips. I had to stop this. An attraction, a connection like that… no, that goes against all my plans for them."

"No, she couldn't have," Adora said in shock.

Catra just carried on. "Adora got defensive, saying she did love Catra and they were going to run away from the Horde, both of them. They didn't care about serving me anymore. Oh, those wretched little brats. They'd both be dead if it wasn't for me and this is the gratitude I get? They barely stood a chance against me

when my magic caught them off guard. I tortured them both for this defiance and wiped their minds of any trace of this… obscene connection they had."

Tears were starting to form in Catra's eyes, and Adora carried on the rest of the entry.

"Was this probably my worst act against them? Yes, but I know for a fact love is a poison. I should know from when I was a young mage in Mystacor, and I found a woman of my own. But I knew it was wrong, that love was a weakness and I... I won't be weak and I won't let my loyal slaves be plagued by such a weakness either. If they ever discovered this… well, I certainly hope they'll be grateful."

"G-Grateful?!" Catra then snapped, tearing the page out. "You stole our first fucking kiss and you thought we'd be grateful! Rot in hell you abusive bitch! Rot in the deepest pit of hell where you fucking belong!"

"Catra…"

"NO!" Catra roared. "You read it too! We were just her fucking slaves… she never wanted us to be happy…"

Adora was crying, tears streaming down her cheeks. "I can't believe it… I saved her life… she did all that to us…"

"No, I take that back," Catra said. "Hell's too good for her." She began to cry as well, and Adora pulled them close. Both of them sobbed together, the force of the revelations they'd read overwhelming them completely. They held each other tightly, still sobbing, their hearts completely in pain.

Words couldn't describe the wound that they felt. Despite the wounds from all this torture being neatly covered up, Adora and Catra knew that Shadow Weaver had ripped something precious from them, a wound still raw and fresh even after all these years. For this, they could never forgive her.

“I hate her…” Catra whispered. “I hate her so goddamn much…”

“Me too…” Adora added. “But… she can’t hurt us again. And no one will go through what we went through again, I promise.”

“And I promise that too,” Catra said. “I’ll be sure as fuck a lot better mother than her when we have kids.”

Adora looked away, regretting having opened that book. “We… We shouldn’t have opened it. The others were right.”

“Wouldn’t be the first mistake we’ve made,” Catra said, standing up and picking up the book. “But we can make amends. I’m going to burn the thing… and we can never speak or think about this again.”

“Are you sure?” Adora wondered.

“No… but it’ll make me feel better, knowing that this last instrument of pain from that monster is gone.”

“You’re right,” Adora agreed. “I think I’ll feel better too.”

She went to a drawer and grabbed a box of matches. Taking one of the matches, Catra quickly lit it and pressed it against the journal… and within moments, it caught aflame. Catra then tossed it out of the window into the valley below, watching it disappear into charred cinders as it fell.

Adora hugged Catra and both of them began to cry again. They’d never get over this and would take this secret to their graves… but at least they had comfort knowing that the monster who had raised them could never bring them harm ever again.

End Notes

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